

"Global Talent Development: Shaping Tomorrow's Workforce"

The ISTD Chennai Chapter conducted its monthly meeting on October 20th, 2024, with a focused panel discussion on **Global Talent Development: Shaping Tomorrow's Workforce**. The virtual event brought together HR professionals and industry leaders to explore the impact of talent development in the age of rapid digital transformation, diversity, and inclusion.

Moderated by **Ms. Anitha Jayapal, Head HR at L&T Edu Tech**, the session aimed to provide actionable insights on building future-ready workforces. Ms. Jayapal, drawing from her vast experience in HR and coaching, emphasized that the future of work requires organizations to be agile, inclusive, and driven by continuous learning.

Key Panelists and Their Contributions:

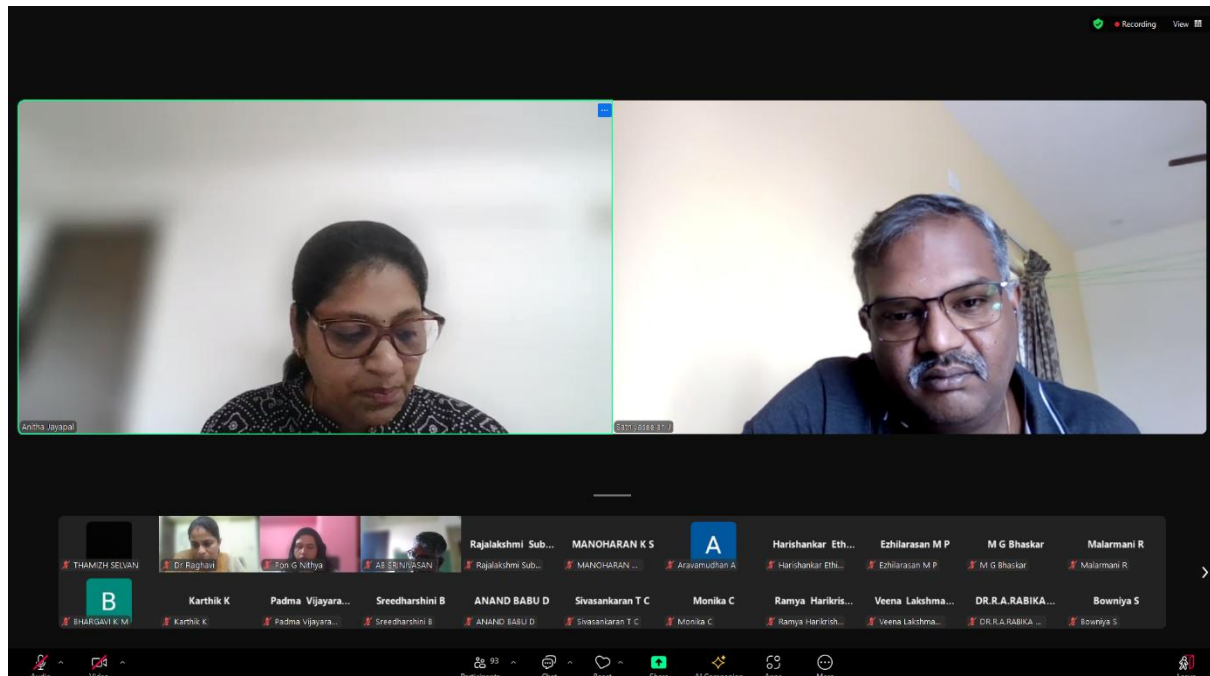
1. Mr. J. Sathiyaseelan

Talent Development Director, Valeo India Pvt . Ltd.

Mr. Sathiyaseelan opened the discussion by highlighting the four dimensions of diversity critical to organizational success: cognitive diversity, demographic diversity, experiential diversity, and organizational diversity. He explained how AI has become a crucial enabler in businesses, particularly in talent management, by using data-driven insights to ensure unbiased hiring practices and effective employee engagement. AI-powered tools, he noted, help identify skill gaps and create personalized learning pathways, ensuring employees remain competitive in evolving business landscapes.

Sathiyaseelan further shared Valeo's initiatives on diversity and inclusion, which integrate marginalized groups, such as persons with disabilities and transgender individuals, into the mainstream workforce. He illustrated how businesses can achieve sustainable growth by creating environments where diverse talent

thrives, supported by inclusive policies, upskilling, and leadership opportunities. Additionally, he emphasized the role of healthy organizational relationships, advocating for mentorship programs and peer support systems that help new employees adjust and flourish in their roles.



2. Ms. Pon G. Nithya

Lead Partner, Talent Development, Prodapt

Ms. Nithya delved into AI's transformative role in talent development at Prodapt, illustrating how AI-driven platforms are being used to enhance leadership pipelines, predict future skill demands, and tailor employee development plans. By leveraging AI, Prodapt is able to track performance trends and assess leadership potential more objectively, which not only boosts efficiency but also fosters a culture of meritocracy and fairness.

On the subject of diversity and inclusion, Ms. Nithya explained Prodapt's holistic approach. She highlighted their commitment to driving gender balance and bringing underrepresented groups into leadership roles. She shared data-backed insights on how a diverse leadership team enhances decision-making and fosters innovation. Nithya also spoke about the importance of **workplace relationships**, emphasizing the necessity of creating an inclusive culture where new team members can build meaningful connections, regardless of their

background. She stressed that fostering these relationships is key to both personal development and organizational success.

Discussion Highlights:

1. AI in Talent and Business Transformation:

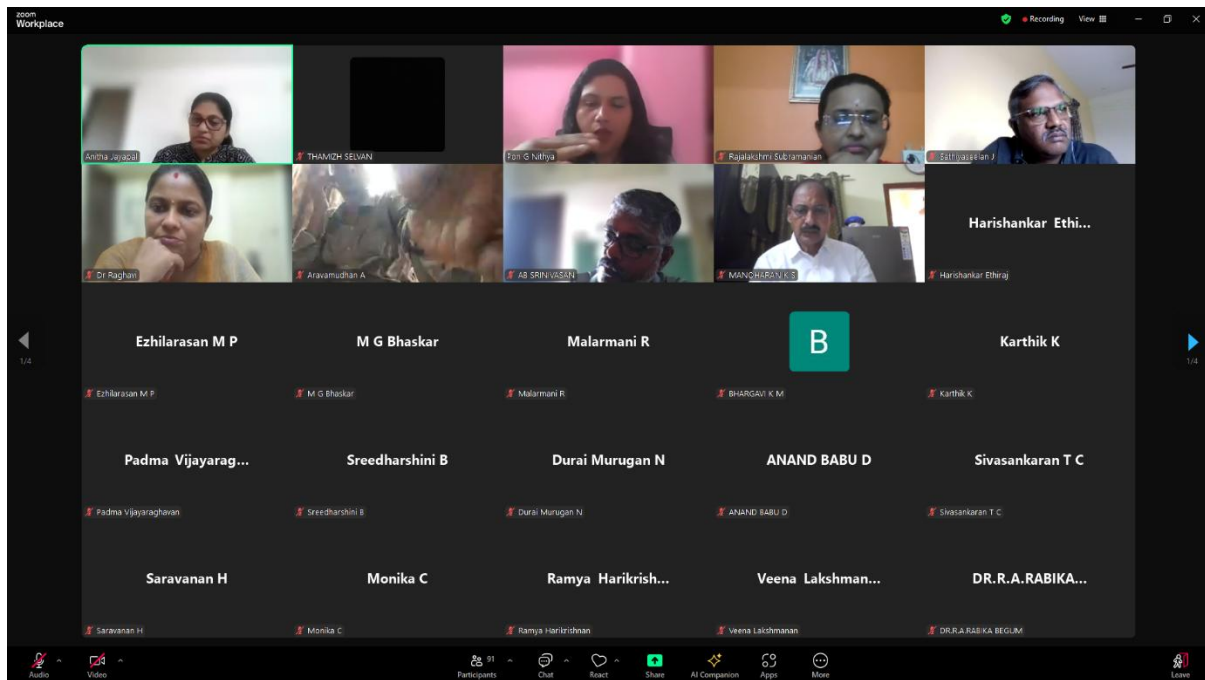
Both panelists emphasized that AI is not just a tool but a strategic driver in modern organizations. AI is being employed to **automate repetitive tasks**, streamline HR operations, and **enhance decision-making** in recruitment, training, and performance management. By using machine learning algorithms, businesses can better anticipate talent needs, identify high-potential employees, and implement **adaptive learning solutions** tailored to individual roles and career paths.

2. Diversity and Inclusion Initiatives:

Diversity and inclusion were central themes throughout the discussion. Both Mr. Sathiyaseelan and Ms. Nithya illustrated how their organizations are making concerted efforts to integrate **four dimensions of diversity**: demographic, experiential, cognitive, and organizational. They argued that by fostering a diverse and inclusive workforce, businesses gain a competitive advantage in global markets and create environments where innovation and creativity flourish.

3. Fostering Healthy Workplace Relationships:

The panelists discussed the importance of mentorship and peer support systems in helping new employees feel welcome and supported. By building strong workplace relationships, organizations can improve employee satisfaction, retention, and overall productivity. Both speakers shared examples from their organizations where mentoring programs have played a vital role in employee growth and engagement.



Interactive Q&A Session:

During the Q&A session, **Major Chandrasekharan** raised pertinent questions about the long-term impact of AI on human job, to which Mr. Sathiyaseelan responded by explaining that AI should be viewed as a tool to augment human capabilities, rather than replace them. He emphasized that AI frees up employees from mundane tasks, allowing them to focus on more strategic, creative, and complex problem-solving activities.

Ms. Nithya also addressed a question about the challenges of implementing diversity initiatives, noting that organizational commitment and leadership buy-in are crucial for the success of such programs. She added that sustained training, awareness, and data-driven policies are essential for creating lasting cultural change.

Closing Remarks:

The session concluded with a message from the moderator, Ms. Anitha Jayapal, who summarized the key takeaways: the imperative for businesses to invest in AI, the critical importance of diversity and inclusion, and the need to foster supportive, relationship-driven work environments. She encouraged participants to take these insights back to their own organizations and implement them to shape the future of work.